

Consent to participate in research: But I want to do it!

Researchers led by Michał Miąskiewicz and Paul L. Harris at Harvard University are running this study, “But I want to do it!”, on Lookit.

Key Information

The following is a short summary of this study to help you decide whether or not you want your child to be a part of this study. More detailed information is listed later on in this form.

Why is my child being invited to take part in the research study?

We invite your child to take part in a research study because your child is between four and eight years of age.

What should I know about the research study?

- Someone will explain this research study to you and your child.
- Whether or not you take part is up to you and your child.
- Your child’s participation is completely voluntary.
- You and your child can choose not to take part.
- You and your child can agree to take part and later change your mind.
- You and your child’s decision will not be held against you.
- You and your child’s refusal to participate will not result in any consequences or any loss of benefits that you and your child are otherwise entitled to receive.

Why is this research being done?

The purpose of this study is to investigate how young children think about situations when a child wants something that conflicts with what their parent wants.

How long will the research last, and what will I/my child need to do?

We expect that your child will be in this research study for 15-20 minutes.

Your child will be asked to record a video of their assent to participate. Your child will hear two stories and answer several questions about them.

You will be asked to record a video of your consent for you and your child’s participation, and to remain present with your child in order to translate your child’s verbal answers into button presses on the screen (if needed.) At the end of the study, you will be asked to complete a brief exit survey. In the survey, you will be asked to choose a privacy level for your/your child’s webcam recordings. You will have the option to withdraw your recordings. You will also be asked to choose whether you would like to give access to your recordings and other data to authorized users of the secure data library Databrary. If you do, other researchers besides us will have access to your recordings. Finally, you will have the opportunity to input any comments or questions for the research team.

Is there any way being in this study could be bad for me or my child?

There is no risk to you or your child. More detailed information about the study procedures can be found below in the section “What happens during this study.”

Will being in this study help me or my child in any way?

We cannot promise any direct benefits to you or your child from your taking part in this short study. However, previous research has shown that the kind of reflection we will ask your child to engage in may help them develop better understanding of other people’s emotions and a greater moral sensitivity. You and your child may also simply find it enjoyable and interesting to talk together about the stories used in this study, which could provide a positive and educational experience for your relationship.

What happens if I do not want my child to be in this research?

Participation in research is completely voluntary. You/your child can decide to participate, not participate, or discontinue participation at any time without penalty or loss of benefits to which your child is otherwise entitled.

You/your child’s alternative to participating in this research study is to not participate.

The following is more detailed information about this study in addition to the information listed above.

Why we are running this study

The purpose of this study is to investigate how young children think about situations when a child wants something that conflicts with what their parent wants. In particular, we are interested in how children understand the morality of such conflicts and what emotions they predict the child and the parent experience in such situations. Answering these questions will help further our understanding of children’s moral development and of the intuitive theories they have about the parent-child relationship.

What happens during this study

This study takes about 15-20 minutes to complete. If you and your child take part in this research, your child will hear two stories and answer several questions about them. The study will be completely online. There will be no real-time interactions with researchers. You and your child can complete the study at any time.

At the start of the study, your child will record a video of their assent to participate. You will record a video of your consent for you and your child’s participation. You will be asked to remain present with your child in order to translate your child’s verbal answers into button presses on the screen (unless your child can read and press the buttons on their own.) You will not be required to be visible in the webcam except when recording consent to participate. At the end of the study, you will have the opportunity to input any comments or questions for the study team.

Participation is voluntary

You and your child are free to choose whether to be in this study. If you do choose to participate, it's okay to stop at any point during the session. Please do pause or stop the session if your child becomes fussy or does not want to participate!

What are the risks?

There is no risk to you or your child. Your child will be asked to think about hypothetical scenarios of the kind they may easily encounter in daily life. These stories are not disturbing and you and your child might even enjoy thinking about them!

However, your child may become bored with the task over time. You or your child can stop the study at any time without loss of benefits.

There is also a (remote) possibility that someone could identify you or your child in the video or that someone who is not supposed to might gain access to your and your child's data. However, the research data (i.e., video and audio recordings, and your child's responses to questions) will be stored on password-protected secure computers maintained by Children Helping Science/Lookit and the Harvard Graduate School of Education. There is an additional risk of disclosure if you choose the "Scientific" or "Publicity" video privacy settings or opt in to share your videos on Databrary.

What are the benefits?

If you and your child agree to take part in this research study, we will email you a \$5 Amazon gift card in recognition of your and your child's time and effort.

To receive the gift card, you must (1) live in the United States and (2) provide a valid consent statement. Your child must (3) be in the age range for the study, (4) be visible on the webcam during the study, and (5) answer questions in English. Additionally, (6) this must be the first time that your child is participating in this study. If these criteria are met, you will receive this compensation within a week of your participation.

Your child will still receive the gift card if your child withdraws before completing the procedures.

Data collection and webcam recording

During the session, you and your child will be recorded by your computer's webcam and microphone. These webcam recordings, and other data like answers you enter in forms, are sent securely to the Lookit platform. You can view your past recordings on Lookit at any time.

Data are stored securely on Lookit servers and by researchers, and are only shared as described in this document. However, there is always a small risk that data transmitted over the internet may be intercepted or that the security of stored data may be compromised.

Who will be able to see your webcam recordings?

We will first check that you really agreed to participate by watching your consent recording. If we cannot confirm that you agreed to participate, no one will view any other recordings from this session.

At the end of the session, you will choose a privacy level for your webcam recordings. You can choose one of the following privacy levels for your videos:

- “Private”: Researchers with access to your recordings will not share them with anyone else.
- “Scientific”: Researchers with access to your recordings may share them for scientific or educational purposes, for instance showing an example in a class or during a scientific conference.
- “Publicity”: Researchers with access to your recordings may also share them for publicity, for instance in a news segment about the research or to recruit more participants.

You will also have the option to withdraw your recordings. If you do, only your consent recording will be kept and all other recordings will be deleted.

Separately, you can opt in to give access to your recordings and other data to authorized users of the secure data library Databrary. This means that other researchers besides the ones running this study will have access to your recordings and may be able to use them to answer other questions about child development. Data sharing can lead to faster progress in research on human development and behavior. Authorized Databrary researchers have to agree to maintain confidentiality and not use the data for commercial purposes. If you have any questions about this data-sharing library, visit [Databrary](https://databrary.org) or email ethics@databrary.org.

How we use your data

If you participate in this study, we (the research group led by Michał Miąskiewicz and Paul L. Harris at Harvard University) will have access to:

- webcam recordings and other data collected during this session
- your account profile and demographic survey
- the child profile for the child who is participating

This includes changes you make in the future to any of this information. We may put different types of information together to learn more about child development. For instance, if your child participates in multiple studies from our group, we may look at how his or her responses compare across studies, or we may look at whether siblings tend to respond similarly. We may also study connections between children's responses and family demographic survey data. However, we are primarily interested in your child's responses to our questions.

Efforts will be made to limit the use and disclosure of your child's Personal Information—including your child's/your name, demographic information, health conditions, and responses to study procedures, as well as your email and highest level of education completed—to people

who have a need to review this information. We cannot promise complete secrecy. Organizations that may inspect and copy your child's information include the IRB and other representatives of this organization. Additionally, you will have the option to grant other researchers on Databrary access to your recordings, survey data, and Lookit account information. It will be securely stored indefinitely. If you change your mind later and would like your data to be withdrawn from Databrary, please email the study team at mmiaskiewicz@g.harvard.edu, and we will delete it immediately.

If identifiers are removed from your child's identifiable private information that are collected during this research, that information could be used for future research studies or distributed to another investigator for future research studies without you or your child's additional informed consent.

How Lookit uses your data

The Lookit core team at MIT will also have access to the data collected during this session, in addition to your account data. They use this data to run and improve Lookit, for instance to provide technical support, check how well data collection is working, or see whether Lookit is reaching a diverse group of families. Lookit stores data indefinitely unless you withdraw your recordings at the end of the study.

Publishing the results of this study

The results of this study may be presented at scientific meetings or published in scientific journals. We may publish individual responses that cannot identify children, like looking times or sequences of button presses. We never publish children's birthdates or names. Even if you choose to share your recordings, we never publish information that would make it possible to link recordings with your demographic data.

What happens if I or my child say yes, but I or my child change our minds later?

You/your child can leave the research at any time; it will not be held against you or your child. Data collected to the point of withdrawal will be stored and analyzed by our trained research team. If you would like to withdraw you/your child's video recordings, please email the study team at mmiaskiewicz@g.harvard.edu, and we will delete them immediately.

Your rights as a participant

You are not waiving any legal claims, rights or remedies because of your participation in this research study. If you have questions, concerns, or complaints, or think the research has hurt your child, talk to the research team at (857) 389-6485 or email mmiaskiewicz@g.harvard.edu.

This research has been reviewed and approved by the Harvard University Area Institutional Review Board ("IRB"). You may talk to them at (617) 496-2847 or cuhs@harvard.edu if:

- Your questions, concerns, or complaints are not being answered by the research team
- You cannot reach the research team
- You want to talk to someone besides the research team
- You have questions about your child's rights as a research subject
- You want to get information or provide input about this research.

Please download or print this consent form for your records.

How to reach us

This study is run by Michał Miaskiewicz and Paul L. Harris at Harvard University. If you or your child have any questions or concerns about this study, or in the very unlikely event of a research-related injury, please contact the research team at (857) 389-6485 or email mmiaskiewicz@g.harvard.edu

If you or your child have any questions or concerns about the Lookit platform, please contact Lookit staff at lookit@mit.edu.